



Basic Presentation Skills

Evaluate Your Presentation Skills

To be a more effective presenter it is useful to examine your present skills. The following evaluation can help identify the areas on which to focus in order to increase your competence. Please read each statement and circle the number that best describes yourself.

DISTRACTION BEHAVIORS		Always					Never				
1.	I identify some basic objectives before planning a presentation	5	4	3	2	1					
2.	I analyze the values, needs and limitations of my audience	5	4	3	2	1					
3.	I write down some main ideas first, in order to build a presentation around them	5	4	3	2	1					
4.	I incorporate both a preview and review of the main ideas	5	4	3	2	1					
5.	I develop an introduction that will catch the attention of my audience and still provide the necessary background information	5	4	3	2	1					
6.	My conclusion refers back to the introduction and, if appropriate, contains a call-to-action statement	5	4	3	2	1					
7.	The visual aids I use are carefully prepared, simple, easy to read, and make an impact	5	4	3	2	1					
8.	The number of visual aids will enhance, not detract from, my presentation	5	4	3	2	1					
9.	I arrange seating (if appropriate) and check audiovisual equipment in advance of the presentation	5	4	3	2	1					
10.	I use anxiety to fuel the enthusiasm of my presentation, not hold me back	5	4	3	2	1					
11.	I communicate ideas enthusiastically	5	4	3	2	1					
12.	I rehearse so there is a minimum use of notes and maximum attention paid to my audience	5	4	3	2	1					
13.	My notes contain only "key words" so I avoid reading from a manuscript	5	4	3	2	1					
14.	My presentations are rehearsed standing up and using visual aids	5	4	3	2	1					
15.	I prepare answers to anticipated questions and practise replying to them	5	4	3	2	1					
16.	My gestures are natural and not restricted by anxiety	5	4	3	2	1					
17.	My voice is strong and clear and not monotonous	5	4	3	2	1					
18.	I use my voice well, by varying the pitch and speed	5	4	3	2	1					
19.	I use pauses as appropriate	5	4	3	2	1					
20.	I maintain good eye contact with the audience, at all times	5	4	3	2	1					
Total Score											

What the score signifies...

- 90-95** You have the qualities of an excellent presenter.
- 70-89** You are above average but could improve in some areas.
- Below 69** You will need to work hard and it may not be easy but with practice, you can make excellent progress.

